People's Movement against the Nizam's Rule — Integrated Student Edition (Readiness Pilot)

Paper II / History and Cultural Heritage of Telangana / Topic 5 | 26 October 2026 | Original practice, not official PYQs

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Official syllabus and chapter map

Source: Telangana State Public Service Commission Notification No. 02/2024, Annexure II, Paper II, Section II, item 5, printed p. 29 (PDF page 29). Direct commission PDF: [source link]tenew.tgpsc.gov.in/preview/RElSRUNUUkVDUlVJVE1FTlROT1RJL05PVElGSUNBVElPTl9OT18wMi0yMDI0X0dyb3VwLUlfU2VydmljZXMgKDEpMjAyNDAyMjAxNDA3MzcucGRmr95v17a0y2d8i13v

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Chronological orientation

Period	Process	Historical distinction
1857–1860 era	Ramji Gond and Gond–Rohilla resistance remembered near Nirmal	Specific execution date and numbers disputed
1930s–1940	Komaram Bheem and Gond resistance around Jodeghat	Forest and cultivation rights; Bheem died in 1940
1930s–1940s	Andhra Mahasabha moves from cultural advocacy into rural organization	Different moderate and left currents
July 1946	Doddi Komaraiah killed at Kadavendi	Major catalyst, not sole origin
1946–1951	Telangana peasant armed struggle	Crosses 1948 integration
August–November 1947	Paramountcy lapses; Standstill Agreement	Temporary arrangement, not accession
13–17 September 1948	Operation Polo and Nizam cessation of resistance	Military integration; social conflicts continue
1951	Communist-led armed struggle withdrawn	Different event from 1948

1. How to frame this topic

This topic combines movements separated by decades, social bases and political aims. Ramji Gond belongs to nineteenth-century Adivasi resistance; Komaram Bheem's struggle arose in the early twentieth-century forest and revenue order; the Telangana peasant armed struggle developed in the 1940s from agrarian conflicts; the Razakar crisis and Indian military intervention belong to the final years of princely Hyderabad. A high-scoring answer must preserve these chronologies instead of presenting one continuous rebellion. The unifying issue is contest over land, forest, coercive authority and political representation under Hyderabad State and, in some frontier contexts, British influence.

2. Hyderabad State in the first half of the twentieth century

Hyderabad remained a princely state under the Nizam, with its own administration but constrained by British paramountcy until 1947. Rural Telangana contained khalsa areas, jagirs, powerful deshmukh families and village-level intermediaries. Tenancy, debt, illegal exactions, vetti and insecurity of cultivation shaped rural grievances. These structures varied across districts. Political organizations therefore encountered a social order in which princely authority and local landed dominance could reinforce one another without being identical.

3. Adivasi resistance: land, forest and authority

Adivasi struggles should be understood through customary access to forests, shifting cultivation, grazing, taxes, policing and encroachment by officials, contractors or non-tribal settlers. State attempts to survey, reserve or tax resources could transform customary practice into an offence. Resistance ranged from flight and refusal to armed action. Tribal movements had their own political languages and should not be interpreted only as preliminary versions of later nationalism. Their history also exposes the limits of archives written primarily by officials suppressing rebellion.

4. Ramji Gond in historical memory

Ramji Gond is remembered as a Gond leader of resistance in the Adilabad region during the nineteenth century. Accounts connect his struggle with opposition to expanding state and colonial influence in the northern Deccan. The documentary record is thinner and less standardized than for twentieth-century political organizations, so exact dates, troop numbers and dramatic narratives require cautious verification. For examination purposes, emphasize the structural background—defence of local autonomy, resources and community authority—while distinguishing well-established historical memory from details that may come from later oral or commemorative traditions.

Context: the northern Deccan frontier

Ramji Gond belongs to a nineteenth-century frontier in which the Gond communities of the Adilabad–Nirmal region faced multiple centres of power. The Nizam's Hyderabad was a princely polity; British influence operated through paramountcy and military and diplomatic arrangements. The local landscape was not a simple two-sided confrontation of one tribe against one government. Forest communities, village headmen, Rohilla groups, revenue agents and officials occupied different positions. In later accounts Ramji Gond is associated with resistance around Nirmal and the defence of local autonomy. To understand his importance, first ask what autonomy meant: access to land and forest, security from coercive collections, the right to settle and cultivate, and the ability of local leaders to mediate disputes without distant interference.

Rebellion, alliances and evidence

A useful historical distinction is between the *existence of remembered resistance* and the precise reconstruction of its course. Some accounts connect Ramji Gond with Rohilla fighters displaced by the upheavals of 1857. That connection is plausible in the broader political setting but each named alliance, troop figure and battlefield episode must be traced to a dated record. The Adilabad District Gazetteer and nineteenth-century Hyderabad-affairs documents have been cited in later historical reporting; the original passages have not yet been independently checked for this edition. This matters because popular summaries disagree about the date of his execution and sometimes describe mass hangings with striking numerical precision. Those figures should not become examination facts merely through repetition.

Significance and limitations

Ramji Gond represents a history of Adivasi political agency that standard narratives centred on British Indian provinces can overlook. His resistance shows how local communities could oppose intrusive authority while pursuing objectives different from the programmes of later nationalist parties. Oral remembrance at Nirmal is itself a historical source: it shows how communities preserved a sense of loss and heroism. Yet memory cannot establish an exact number of executions or an unambiguous sequence of operations. A defensible mains answer separates the broad pattern—Gond resistance to coercive political expansion—from disputed specifics, and explains the relationship between the 1857-era upheavals, Hyderabad State and local Gond leadership without conflating them.

Exam interpretation

For a question on Adivasi revolts, use Ramji Gond as the nineteenth-century example, then compare him with Komaram Bheem in the 1930s–1940. Explain the common resource and autonomy questions but state that their opponents, administrative circumstances, evidence base and political vocabulary differed. Avoid the claim that Ramji Gond's execution occurred before the 1857 uprising; published accounts contain contradictory dates. The verified conclusion is that his memory remains important to the political history of northern Telangana, while specific dramatic details require primary-document confirmation.

5. Komaram Bheem and the Gond world of Adilabad

Komaram Bheem became a major symbol of Gond resistance in the Adilabad region under the Nizam. His struggle emerged from conflicts involving forest access, cultivation, official coercion and the rights of tribal communities. The slogan commonly rendered as “Jal, Jangal, Zameen” captures later public memory of rights over water, forest and land; historians should verify the exact contemporary textual provenance before treating it as a verbatim archival slogan. Bheem was killed at Jodeghat in 1940. His historical significance lies in articulating local autonomy and resource rights in a political order that marginalized Adivasi communities.

Forest society and the origins of conflict

Komaram Bheem's struggle developed among Gond communities in the Adilabad forest zone of Hyderabad State. Cultivation in such areas depended on a relationship among land, forest products, grazing, shifting cultivation and seasonal movement. A household's claim to a cultivated plot might be based on labour and customary recognition rather than a document acceptable to revenue officers. Once forest boundaries, taxation or private claims were enforced through formal administration, the same cultivation could be labelled encroachment. The social problem was therefore not only poverty: it was a conflict over who possessed the authority to define legitimate land use.

Organization and Jodeghat

Bheem is associated with resistance around Jodeghat and nearby settlements. Local grievances included restrictions on cultivation and collection of dues, harassment by intermediaries and loss of control over forest resources. Accounts of his life also circulate in oral traditions and later biographies; details of travel, specific negotiations and numbers of followers are not equally documented. The movement's distinctive feature was the demand that Adivasi communities be treated as political actors with claims to territory and livelihood, not simply as subjects to be administered. Bheem died in a confrontation at Jodeghat in 1940. Exact day and month are inconsistently given in public accounts, so this edition uses the securely supported year rather than presenting a disputed date as settled.

Meaning of 'Jal, Jangal, Zameen'

The phrase 'water, forest, land' is strongly associated with Bheem's public legacy. It provides a useful three-part analytical framework: water for cultivation and settlement, forest for livelihood and cultural practices, and land for secure possession and collective autonomy. But the exact contemporary wording and first attestation of the slogan have not been verified from a 1940 document. An examination answer can accurately say that the slogan *expresses his remembered legacy*, rather than quoting it as a proven verbatim statement. This distinction is not pedantry: it teaches the difference between historical action and the language through which later generations honour it.

Historical importance and later remembrance

Bheem's movement shows that Adivasi resistance cannot be absorbed completely into either Congress nationalism or communist peasant politics. Gond claims were shaped by forest ecology, customary tenure, official authority and community dignity. The Telangana government has subsequently memorialised Bheem, including a Jodeghat tribal museum noted in the state's 2015 Socio-Economic Outlook. Such memorials are valuable evidence for *public remembrance*, not independent proof of every episode in his biography. A strong comparison with Ramji Gond should show continuity in resource-based resistance but discontinuity in period, administrative context and documentary sources.

6. From cultural organization to agrarian mobilization

Andhra Mahasabha began as a cultural and social platform but parts of the organization became increasingly involved with rural grievances. Activists worked in villages, organized meetings and publicized complaints against vetti, illegal levies and landlord power. This transition did not occur uniformly across the whole organization. Moderate and left-oriented strands diverged, and by the 1940s communist organizers increasingly shaped peasant mobilization in several districts. This institutional history links Topic 4’s socio-cultural awakening with Topic 5’s agrarian struggle.

7. Agrarian causes of the Telangana peasant struggle

The armed struggle developed from concrete rural conflicts: insecurity of tenants, concentration of land, forced labour, illegal exactions, debt and coercion by dominant landlords and their agents. The term “feudal” captures important hierarchical relations but should not substitute for identifying actual institutions such as jagirs, deshmukhs, tenancy and vetti. Village conditions varied. Some conflicts arose around eviction or land possession, others around forced services or political repression. Agrarian grievances became revolutionary when organization supplied collective leadership, armed self-defence and a wider programme of change.

The agrarian system: distinguish institutions

A large proportion of rural Telangana's conflicts concerned control over the means of cultivation. *Jagir* referred to a revenue/territorial grant arrangement, while *khalsa* denoted areas administered more directly by the state. *Deshmukh* identified a powerful revenue-linked and landholding position in many local contexts; *patel* and *patwari* were village-level offices associated with administration and records. These terms are not interchangeable, and not every landlord held the same formal title. Tenants could face eviction or insecurity even when they cultivated land for years. Debt could compel them to accept unfavourable conditions, and local authority might combine economic power with access to police or administrative officials.

Vetti and illegal exactions

Vetti means coerced or unpaid labour demanded through unequal power relations. Its burden could fall on service castes, agricultural labourers and other subordinate households. The injury was both economic and political: time taken for compulsory service reduced labour available for one's own livelihood, while refusal could bring punishment. Additional levies, gifts, transport services or grain demands varied locally. A textbook explanation must therefore move beyond the sentence 'peasants opposed feudal exploitation': it should identify the mechanism by which work, crops and security were extracted. One village might mobilise over a disputed harvest; another over tenancy or compulsory labour.

From grievance to organized movement

Material suffering alone does not explain why a movement develops at a particular moment. Organization matters. Meetings make private experiences visible as shared grievances; village committees coordinate refusal; sympathetic activists help with communication across settlements; repression can widen solidarity or break it. The Andhra Mahasabha and communist cadres provided important organizational channels, but they did not create all grievances from above. Local peasants, agricultural labourers and women supplied initiative, risk and practical knowledge. The social origins of the uprising have been analysed in D. N. Dhanagare's 1974 scholarship, while John Roosa's later study argues that nationalism and the political circumstances of independence must also be considered alongside agrarian property relations.

Why 1946 became a turning point

The killing of Doddi Komaraiah at Kadavendi in July 1946 is widely treated as a catalytic event. It should not be described as the *sole cause* of the armed struggle. Organized protest already existed; the killing symbolised the coercion peasants faced and helped mobilise others. In some localities, defensive squads and armed resistance followed escalating confrontation. The movement's goals expanded from immediate relief against exactions to challenges against landlord control and, in certain areas, alternative village authority. The result was a struggle that cannot be reduced either to a military rebellion against the Nizam or to an ordinary rent dispute.

8. Doddi Komaraiah and the transition to armed struggle

Doddi Komaraiah’s killing in 1946 at Kadavendi became a major turning point in the memory of the Telangana struggle. His death is associated with confrontation between organized peasants and landlord power and helped intensify mobilization. The event should be situated within a longer build-up of village organization rather than treated as the solitary cause of the entire conflict. Commemorations of Komaraiah later became an important symbol of sacrifice in Telangana political memory.

9. Role of the Communist Party

Communist activists helped transform local agrarian grievances into coordinated organization. They worked through village sanghams, mobilized tenants and agricultural labourers, and advocated land redistribution and resistance to forced labour and landlord coercion. Armed squads developed in the context of escalating repression. Communist leadership gave the movement ideological coherence, but peasant participation also reflected local grievances that cannot be reduced to party instruction. The relationship between party strategy and village initiative changed across phases of the struggle.

10. Village sanghams and alternative authority

Village-level organizations could challenge the everyday power of landlords and officials by settling disputes, enforcing decisions, resisting vetti and mobilizing grain or resources. In some areas, the movement displaced established authority enough to create forms of parallel local control. Claims about the number of villages or exact acreage redistributed vary by source and should be cited carefully. The broader significance is clear: the struggle sought not only to protest rulers but to alter relations of land, labour and authority inside the village.

The village sangham as an institution

A sangham was more than a crowd assembled for protest. At village level, organization could keep lists of grievances, convene meetings, coordinate refusal of compulsory services, protect threatened tenants and arrange communication with neighbouring settlements. These actions reduced the isolation of individuals who otherwise faced a powerful landlord or village official alone. A demand such as 'no vetti' acquired practical force when several households refused together and volunteers helped protect them against retaliation. The transition from private complaint to public collective action was itself a political transformation.

The changing balance of authority

Where sanghams became influential, disputes over land and labour could be taken to local committees rather than settled entirely through the customary power of landlords. Some movement accounts describe village committees that protected crops, challenged evictions, redistributed land or organized collective defence. However, their reach and durability varied; a committee could be influential in one cluster of villages but absent elsewhere. Quantitative claims about acres distributed, number of villages controlled and duration of parallel administration differ between partisan memoirs and subsequent scholarship. Until these figures are cross-checked, the safest conclusion is qualitative: in parts of Telangana, peasant organization contested everyday rural authority, not just the princely ruler at Hyderabad.

From civil resistance to armed squads

Armed action was neither the first nor the only form of peasant participation. Petitions, meetings, grain protection, refusal of forced labour and defensive mobilization preceded or accompanied violence. As landlords' agents, state police and later other armed forces responded, some local units formed armed squads. This was a significant strategic escalation because the movement now faced questions of civilian safety, discipline, weapons, supply and relations with nonparticipating villagers. In a balanced answer, explain both the pressures that encouraged armed defence and the human costs of militarization.

The peasant as historical actor

A social-history approach asks who took decisions and what changed in daily life. Agricultural labourers could seek an end to forced work; tenants wanted security of possession; poorer women might defend crops or carry information; small cultivators feared eviction and debt. Their interests overlapped but were not identical. Some were willing to support agrarian demands without supporting a prolonged guerrilla war. This is why the movement must be studied across its phases and not assigned a single timeless ideology. Its legacy includes political mobilization, pressure for agrarian reform and an enduring debate over the limits of armed methods.

11. Women in the Telangana armed struggle

Women participated as couriers, organizers, agricultural workers, shelter providers, cultural activists and, in some cases, armed participants. Their involvement challenged restrictions on mobility and public action but did not automatically remove patriarchy within households or political organizations. Sexual violence and coercion formed part of the broader context of repression and conflict. A gendered account should therefore study both political agency and vulnerability rather than add women as a short list of famous names.

Why gender changes the explanation

Women were not merely supporters of male combatants. They cultivated fields, managed households under threat, carried messages, sheltered activists, joined meetings and sometimes participated directly in resistance. A campaign against forced labour or landlord coercion affected women through both productive work and household survival. When male family members were imprisoned, absent or underground, women could become central to maintaining networks. Their work was often less visible in official records because administrators documented arrests and weapons more readily than food, shelter and communications.

Chakali Ailamma as a case study

Chityala (Chakali) Ailamma is remembered for resisting landlord attempts to seize the produce of land she cultivated in the Palakurthi area. Her case illustrates the convergence of caste, gender, tenancy and organized resistance. The immediate issue concerned a concrete harvest and the right of a cultivating household to retain it; it was not merely an abstract demand for freedom. Accounts of sangham involvement show how collective support could make a poor woman's refusal politically consequential. Precise legal documents, acreage and the full chronology of the dispute still require archival verification. In mains answers, use Ailamma to explain a *mechanism* of mobilization rather than adding her name without analysis.

Multiple forms of participation

Women could organize meetings and protest processions, serve as couriers and messengers, maintain clandestine contacts, gather provisions, perform songs and theatre, and in some cases take part in armed units. These activities were not interchangeable: the dangers faced by a courier differed from those of a public organizer or a family providing shelter. The movement's cultural sphere mattered because songs could communicate land and labour demands where formal literacy was limited. At the same time, women faced intimidation, sexual violence and burdens of displacement. A historically adequate account recognizes both agency and vulnerability without reducing women to victims.

Limits of emancipation

Participation in a radical movement did not automatically abolish patriarchy, caste hierarchy or unequal domestic work. Political organizations could depend on women's labour while retaining male-dominated leadership. After demobilization, many women faced pressure to return to conventional roles, and the preservation of their stories depended heavily on memoirs and later oral-history projects. A complete assessment therefore asks whether women gained durable rights to land, representation and personal autonomy, not simply whether they participated. This distinction between participation and structural transformation strengthens any mains conclusion.

12. State repression and the Razakar context

As the Nizam’s government faced growing political crisis after 1947, repression of opponents intensified in many areas. Police, local elites and armed organizations interacted in complex ways. Razakar activity is remembered particularly for coercion and violence against political opponents and civilians. Historical writing must distinguish the formal Hyderabad State forces from the Razakar volunteer organization even though both operated in the same political crisis. Violence also varied geographically, and communal interpretation should not erase the agrarian dimensions of the conflict.

13. Majlis-e-Ittehadul-Muslimeen

The Majlis-e-Ittehadul-Muslimeen became an influential political organization in late princely Hyderabad. Under Bahadur Yar Jung and later Qasim Razvi, its politics changed in context and tone. By the late 1940s, Razvi’s leadership became associated with a hardline defence of the Nizam’s sovereignty and opposition to accession to India. It is important not to treat all Muslims in Hyderabad as supporters of the Majlis or Razakars; Muslim political opinion was diverse, and many citizens opposed coercion and communal polarization.

14. Qasim Razvi and the Razakars

Qasim Razvi became the most prominent leader of the Razakars, a volunteer force associated with the Majlis. The organization expanded during the 1947–48 crisis and became notorious for intimidation, armed violence and attempts to suppress opponents of the Nizam’s political position. Numbers claimed for Razakar membership vary dramatically in political and historical literature. A careful answer therefore emphasizes their role in escalating insecurity and communal tension without repeating unverified membership figures.

MIM, Razvi and the Razakars: separate the institutions

The Majlis-e-Ittehadul-Muslimeen was a political organization within princely Hyderabad. The Razakars were a volunteer armed organization associated with its hardline politics in the late 1940s; they were not identical to the entire Muslim population, to all MIM members or to the regular Hyderabad State army. Qasim (Kasim) Razvi emerged as a prominent leader in this period and championed resistance to accession. To say that Razakars acted in defence of the Nizam's position does not mean every official of the princely government controlled every Razakar action. The distinction is essential for both factual precision and avoiding collective blame.

Why the crisis escalated

The lapse of British paramountcy in August 1947 created a dispute over Hyderabad's political future. The Nizam sought a position apart from the Indian Union; Indian leaders considered an independent enclave geographically surrounded by India untenable. Internal demands for responsible government, agrarian resistance and communal tension intensified the crisis. Razakar intimidation and attacks on opponents contributed to insecurity, but this occurred alongside multiple kinds of violence and political mobilization. A good answer links the Razakar phenomenon to the breakdown of negotiation without treating it as the only cause of intervention.

Civilian consequences and historical method

Communal identity cannot substitute for evidence of responsibility. Muslims in Hyderabad included opponents of Razvi and people who later suffered reprisals. Hindus included supporters of different political positions; class, region and locality also shaped experience. Accounts of the period are often partisan, with inconsistent claims about the size of the Razakar force and the number of casualties. An accurate chapter distinguishes the verified institutional relationship (MIM, Razvi, Razakars) from contested numerical or accusatory claims. Violence should be studied with reference to victims, perpetrators, dates and independent corroboration, not with generalized community labels.

15. Hyderabad after Indian independence in 1947

When British paramountcy lapsed in 1947, princely states faced decisions about accession. The Nizam initially sought an arrangement that would preserve Hyderabad's independence. A Standstill Agreement with India temporarily maintained existing arrangements while negotiations continued. Hyderabad's geographic position inside the Indian Union, political agitation within the state, the Razakar crisis and security concerns made the arrangement unstable. The problem involved international law, princely sovereignty, internal democracy and the security strategy of the new Indian government.

16. Standstill Agreement and failure of negotiation

The Standstill Agreement was meant to create time for negotiation, but mutual accusations soon undermined it. India criticized Razakar violence and Hyderabad's political posture; Hyderabad complained of pressure and interference. Internal opposition to autocratic rule continued. The failure of negotiation illustrates a central tension of decolonization: the legal claims of a princely ruler could conflict with geography, popular political movements and the integration objectives of the successor state.

17. Operation Polo / Police Action, September 1948

Indian forces entered Hyderabad State on 13 September 1948 in the military operation officially termed a "Police Action" and commonly known as Operation Polo. The campaign ended within days, and the Nizam announced the cessation of resistance on 17 September. The rapid military outcome ended the princely state's independent strategic position and opened the way for its integration into the Indian Union. The term "Police Action" is the contemporary official label, but analytically the event involved organized military force; both terminology and political interpretation remain subjects of public debate.

Constitutional background and negotiations

British paramountcy lapsed in August 1947. The Nizam sought to avoid immediate accession to India, while the Indian government pursued integration of princely territories. The November 1947 Standstill Agreement was intended to preserve certain arrangements temporarily while negotiations continued; it was not a final settlement of sovereignty. Political and security disagreements persisted. An answer should explain both sides' stated positions while recognizing that Hyderabad was geographically surrounded by Indian territory and contained its own demands for representative government.

Operation Polo: event and chronology

Indian forces entered Hyderabad on 13 September 1948 in Operation Polo. Contemporary Indian official language called it a 'Police Action', but the operation was carried out by military forces. The Nizam announced cessation of resistance on 17 September; administrative and military transitions followed. The five-day chronology is useful for examinations, but do not equate a ceasefire announcement with the instantaneous completion of every legal, administrative and social process. The key outcome was the end of the Nizam's attempt to maintain Hyderabad outside the Indian Union and the establishment of Indian control over the territory.

Why it happened: multiple causes

Four pressures converged: failed political negotiation, India's strategic objection to an enclave, Razakar-linked coercion and disorder, and demands from movements inside Hyderabad against autocratic government and agrarian domination. The peasant armed struggle was already under way and followed its own chronology. Treating it merely as an Indian Army auxiliary or as a conflict created by 1948 misses the 1946 origins. Conversely, explaining Operation Polo solely through the peasant struggle ignores the wider accession dispute. A high-scoring answer distinguishes immediate triggers from structural conditions and identifies the decisions of both the Hyderabad and Indian governments.

Consequences, including uncomfortable ones

Integration was a major constitutional and territorial turning point. Yet communal violence during and after the intervention must be acknowledged. The Sunderlal investigation, based on post-action visits and interviews, is frequently cited in debates over casualties. Its estimates are not a direct census, and scholars discuss the limits of sampling, access and political context. This edition does not reproduce a precise casualty total without consulting the original report. The communist-led peasant struggle continued after 1948 and was withdrawn in 1951, demonstrating that integration of a state and resolution of its agrarian conflicts were distinct historical processes.

18. Violence surrounding integration

The end of the Nizam's rule did not mean violence ceased immediately. The 1947–48 crisis included Razakar violence, communal attacks, agrarian conflict and violence during or after the Indian intervention. The Government of India appointed a committee led by Pandit Sunderlal to investigate communal violence; later discussions of its findings have produced differing estimates and political interpretations. Responsible history acknowledges civilian suffering across communities and avoids using uncertain numbers as rhetorical weapons. This complexity is essential to a balanced account of integration.

19. End of princely rule and administrative transition

After the military action, the Nizam remained for a period as a constitutional head while effective political authority shifted toward the Indian Union and new administrative arrangements. Hyderabad State did not disappear overnight as a territorial unit; it continued through a transition before later linguistic reorganization. The integration process therefore has military, constitutional and administrative phases. Distinguish September 1948 from the later formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1956.

20. Continuation and withdrawal of the armed struggle

The communist-led Telangana armed struggle did not end immediately with Operation Polo. Communist forces continued resistance for a period under changed political conditions, now facing the Indian state rather than the Nizam's regime. Party strategy, repression, changing electoral possibilities and agrarian conditions shaped the eventual withdrawal in 1951. This chronology matters because treating 17 September 1948 as the end of every Telangana struggle conflates princely-state integration with the separate trajectory of peasant armed mobilization.

After September 1948: why armed conflict persisted

The transfer of effective authority from the Nizam to the Indian Union changed the identity of the state confronting communist-led guerrilla forces, but did not automatically settle tenants' claims or village power relations. Some peasants feared restoration of landlords' influence or loss of land secured during the struggle. The Communist Party faced difficult strategic questions: whether to continue armed resistance, seek negotiated concessions or shift toward constitutional politics. Repression, the possibility of elections and disagreements within the movement all influenced the changing course of action. The struggle's withdrawal in 1951 is an essential date and must not be erased by an account that ends on 17 September 1948.

Evaluating results

Immediate outcomes were mixed. The armed struggle did not achieve a permanent revolutionary state, and many communities endured violence, arrests and displacement. Nevertheless, it altered the political visibility of tenancy, forced labour and rural inequality. It contributed to the wider climate in which agrarian reform and democratic participation became unavoidable public questions. Avoid a mechanically triumphant narrative: the question is not simply whether rebels won or lost militarily, but how far their demands changed institutions and expectations. A well-supported conclusion distinguishes short-term suppression, partial reforms and long-term political memory.

21. Land and social consequences

The struggle placed tenancy, vetti and landlord power at the center of Telangana politics. Even where revolutionary land redistribution was later reversed or legally contested, the movement altered political expectations and contributed to pressure for agrarian reform. It also created a durable memory of peasant organization and martyrdom. Assessment should distinguish immediate military outcomes from longer-term influence on land policy, party politics and regional identity.

22. Competing memories of September 17

September 17 has been described in public discourse using terms such as integration, merger, liberation and, by the Telangana government from 2024 onward, Praja Palana Dinotsavam. Each term highlights a different political interpretation. Historians should identify the institutional event—Hyderabad's incorporation into the Indian Union following military action—before discussing later commemorative language. Public memory is itself historically significant, but it should not substitute for evidence about 1948.

23. Current affairs: Praja Palana Dinotsavam 2026

On 17 September 2026, the Telangana government officially observed Praja Palana Dinotsavam at Public Gardens, Hyderabad. The state portal described 17 September 1948 as the date Hyderabad State officially became an integral part of India and framed it as a transition from princely to democratic governance. The speech also invoked Telangana's history of opposition to oppression, landlord dominance and autocratic rule. This is a useful current-affairs link for mains answers, provided the government's commemorative framing is identified as a present-day official interpretation rather than treated as the only historical vocabulary.

24. Historiography: sources and disagreements

Sources include police and intelligence records, communist party documents, memoirs of activists, oral traditions, administrative correspondence, diplomatic records and later scholarship. Each source has interests and silences. Communist narratives may emphasize class struggle; official state records may foreground law and order; communal accounts can selectively record victimization. Cross-verification is essential. For Ramji Gond and Komaram Bheem, oral memory must be read alongside documentary and anthropological evidence. For 1948 violence, avoid unsupported numerical precision.

25. Integrated mains framework

A strong answer can be organized in four layers: Adivasi resistance over resources; agrarian mobilization against landlordism and vetti; political crisis involving MIM/Razakars and accession; military integration and the continuing communist struggle. Explain how these layers overlapped without merging them. Use Komaram Bheem, Doddi Komaraiah, Andhra Mahasabha, village sanghams, Qasim Razvi and Operation Polo as anchor examples. End by noting that integration solved the question of princely sovereignty but not all agrarian, social or regional inequalities.

Resistance movements: distinctions and named actors

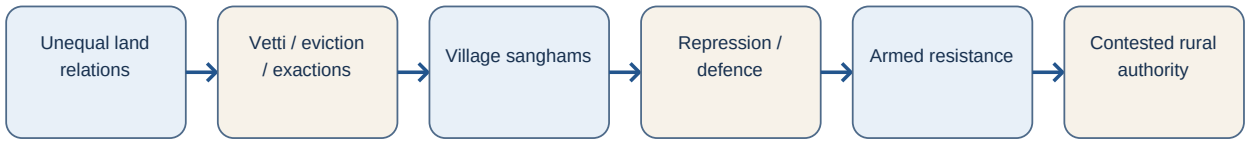
Ramji Gond (nineteenth-century Adivasi resistance) and **Komaram Bheem** (twentieth-century Gond resistance) occupied different political settings; Bheem is associated with the slogan **Jal–Jangal–Zameen** in popular memory, but the exact contemporaneous wording should be source-audited. **Telangana peasant armed struggle (1946–51)** involved landless and tenant cultivators, Andhra Mahasabha activists, Communist organisers, village-level resistance to vetti and landlord domination, and periods of violent repression. **Razia/rulers?** Do not invent named persons or incidents; use documented people such as **Chakali Ailamma** and **Doddi Komaraiah** with their specific village and historical context after source checking. Distinguish the **Razakars**, the Majlis political milieu and the **Indian military operation of September 1948** (Operation Polo) from the continuing struggle in parts of the countryside after the Union takeover. A balanced response examines popular agrarian agency, repression, caste/class relationships, gender and the contested chronology of integration.

Comparative revision: four connected but distinct movements

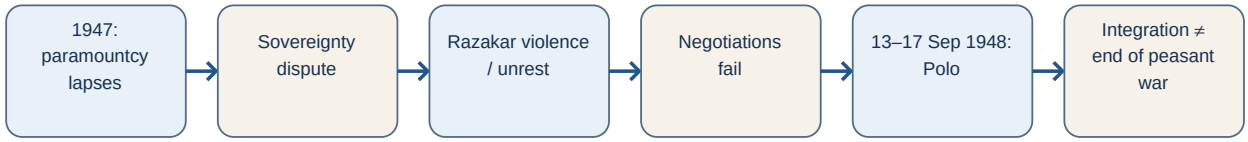
Dimension	Ramji Gond	Komaram Bheem	Telangana peasant struggle	Hyderabad integration
Main period	Mid-19th century	1930s–1940	1946–1951	1947–1948
Principal social issue	Local Gond autonomy	Forest and land claims	Tenancy, vetti, landlord coercion	Sovereignty, order, accession
Key actors	Gond groups; remembered Rohilla allies	Gond communities; Bheem	Sanghams, peasants, Communist cadres	Nizam, Indian government, Razvi/Razakars
Central distinction	Oral memory and disputed dates	Adivasi resource politics	Class/caste and village authority	Military and constitutional change

Learning diagrams (conceptual, not geographic maps)

Agrarian escalation



Hyderabad crisis and divergent outcomes



Historical evidence ladder

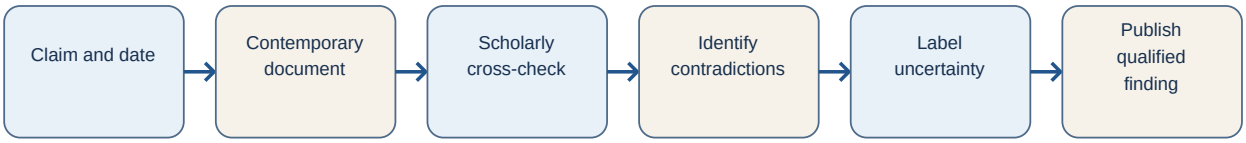


Diagram 1 — Agrarian escalation: unequal land relations vetti / eviction / exactions collective sanghams repression and defence armed squads contested village authority.

Diagram 2 — Hyderabad crisis: lapse of paramountcy sovereignty disagreement + internal political agitation + Razakar violence failed Standstill negotiations Operation Polo integration; separately, peasant armed struggle continues to 1951.

Diagram 3 — Evidence discipline: historical claim contemporary primary record / reputable scholarship cross-check contradiction label verified / provisional / contested student-facing statement.

Source-critical register (internal academic readiness evidence)

• **S01 — Official syllabus wording, 2024.** TGPSC Notification 02/2024, Annexure II p.29. **PRIMARY VERIFIED.** [source link]tenew.tgpsc.gov.in/preview/RElSRUNUUkVDUlVJVE1FTlROT1RJL05PVElGSUNBVElPTl9OT18wMi0yMDI0X0dyb3VwLUlfU2VydmljZXMgKDEpMjAyNDAyMjAxNDA3MzcucGRmr95v17a0y2d8i13v

• **S02 — Social origins and agrarian structure of 1946–51 struggle.** D. N. Dhanagare, 1974, Indian Economic and Social History Review. **SCHOLARLY VERIFIED ABSTRACT/INDEX; FULL ARTICLE NOT INSPECTED.** [source link]ls.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/006996677400800107

• **S03 — Political/national context of peasant revolt.** John Roosa, Journal of Peasant Studies, 2001. **SCHOLARLY VERIFIED ABSTRACT; FULL ARTICLE NOT INSPECTED.** [source link]tandfonline.com/doi/abs/10.1080/03066150108438783

• **S04 — Bheem memorial at Jodeghat.** Telangana Socio-Economic Outlook 2015. **GOVERNMENT PRIMARY VERIFIED.** https://telangana.gov.in/wp-content/uploads/2023/05/Socio-Economic-outlook-2015.pdf

• **S05 — Ramji Gond: chronology and Nirmal memory.** S. Harpal Singh, The News Minute, 2023; cites District Gazetteer and Hyderabad Affairs. **SECONDARY; ORIGINAL GAZETTEER NOT RETRIEVED; DISPUTED EXECUTION DATE.** [source link]thenewsminute.com/amp/story/andhra-pradesh/ramji-gond-s-martyrdom-anniversary-retelling-19th-century-legend-175663

• **S06 — Post-1948 communal violence and Sunderlal report.** History for Peace historical review, 2022. **SECONDARY ANALYSIS; ORIGINAL SUNDERLAL FILE NOT INSPECTED.** [source link]toryforpeace.pw/post/forgotten-histories-hyderabad-s-annexation-to-india

• **S07 — Operation Polo dates and official characterization.** Government of India, Central Bureau of Communication, 2025. **GOVERNMENT EXPLAINER; NOT ORIGINAL 1948 OPERATION ORDER.** [source link]tent/themes/boc/mann_ki_baat/e_august_2025/files/basic-html/page52.html

• **S08 — 2026 Praja Palana Dinotsavam commemoration.** Telangana State Portal, 17 Sep 2026. **PRIMARY GOVERNMENT COMMEMORATION, NOT PRIMARY 1948 HISTORY.** [source link]telangana.gov.in/news/press-releases/2026/09/honble-cm-sri-a-revanth-reddy-participated-in-telangana-praja-palana-dinotsavam-2026-celebrations-at-public-gardens-hyderabad/

• **S09 — Women in armed struggle.** Rajat Kumar Tirkey, Journal of Historical Studies and Research 2025. **SECONDARY; JOURNAL PDF INDEXED.** [source link]tent/uploads/2025/03/36-45-JHSRV5-N1-Rajat-Kumar-Tirkey.pdf

Outstanding primary documents: Ramji Gond Gazetteer/Hyderabad Affairs originals; 1940 Jodeghat contemporaneous police/forest records; original Andhra Mahasabha conference minutes; Hyderabad 1947 Standstill Agreement text; Razakar/Hyderabad government orders; original Sunderlal investigation; 1951 Communist Party withdrawal resolution. Do not present unsupported troop counts, acreage, casualty estimates, or exact oral slogans as verified facts.

Thirty original explained MCQs (practice, NOT official PYQs)

MCQ 1. Which pair correctly distinguishes two Adivasi leaders in Telangana history?

A. Ramji Gond—19th century; Komaram Bheem—1940 Jodeghat B. Ramji Gond—1948; Komaram Bheem—1857 C. Both led the 1951 communist withdrawal D. Both commanded Operation Polo

Answer: A. Ramji Gond is remembered in the nineteenth-century Nirmal/Adilabad resistance context, whereas Bheem died at Jodeghat in 1940. Treat the detailed Ramji execution chronology as disputed.

MCQ 2. Komaram Bheem is chiefly associated with which region?

A. Kadavendi B. Jodeghat in the Adilabad forest zone C. Golconda Fort D. Bhongir town

Answer: B. Jodeghat is associated with Bheem and Gond resource-rights resistance. Kadavendi is linked to Doddi Komaraiah and the agrarian struggle.

MCQ 3. The remembered phrase “Jal, Jangal, Zameen” best expresses claims to

A. Water, forests and land B. Jobs, education and industry C. Religion, language and literature D. Courts, police and taxation only

Answer: A. The phrase summarises water, forest and land rights associated with Bheem’s public legacy. Its exact verbatim use in 1940 has not been established from a contemporaneous record.

MCQ 4. Why must Ramji Gond’s precise execution date be treated cautiously?

A. No memory of his resistance exists B. Later sources disagree and original records need checking C. The Nizam never ruled Hyderabad D. All nineteenth-century events lack documents

Answer: B. Later reporting describes contradictory chronologies and cites earlier gazetteer material not yet checked directly. Historical memory is not proof of a precise day or number of executions.

MCQ 5. Which is a central structural cause of the Telangana peasant struggle?

A. Coastal port customs B. Insecure tenancy and forced labour C. Decline of Roman trade D. Only a dispute over official language

Answer: B. Tenancy insecurity, vetti, illegal exactions, debt and landlord coercion were material grievances. Language activism mattered to organization but does not explain the agrarian conflict alone.

MCQ 6. What does vetti refer to in this context?

A. Compulsory or unpaid labour imposed through unequal power B. A cash crop C. An armed Razakar regiment D. A constitutional office

Answer: A. Vetti imposed coerced labour on subordinate households. Its impact included lost livelihood time, dependency and the threat of retaliation for refusal.

MCQ 7. What was a village sangham in the peasant struggle?

A. A permanent princely court B. A collective organization for rural demands and resistance C. A unit of the Indian Army D. An office of the Nizam

Answer: B. Sanghams organized meetings, defended cultivators, resisted vetti and sometimes challenged landlord authority. Their strength varied from village to village.

MCQ 8. Doddi Komaraiah is associated with which village?

A. Jodeghat B. Kadavendi C. Sirpur D. Nirmal

Answer: B. Komaraiah was killed at Kadavendi in 1946, a catalyst in the wider agrarian mobilization. Do not confuse this with Bheem's Jodeghat.

MCQ 9. Which statement about July 1946 is strongest?

A. The armed struggle began only because of one killing B. Komaraiah's killing intensified an already developing movement C. Hyderabad acceded to India in July 1946 D. The Communist Party withdrew in July 1946

Answer: B. Komaraiah's death became a turning point, but organizing against rural exactions and landlord power predated it. A monocausal explanation is historically weak.

MCQ 10. Andhra Mahasabha's role in the 1940s is best described as

A. Only a military branch of the Razakars B. A cultural platform whose sections developed rural political mobilization C. The government of India after 1948 D. A 1956 linguistic reorganization committee

Answer: B. Andhra Mahasabha had cultural origins and changing political currents; activists helped bring agrarian grievances into organized politics. It was not uniformly communist from its beginning.

MCQ 11. Which is a sound description of communist participation?

A. Peasant agency was irrelevant B. Cadres coordinated sanghams and armed resistance amid local grievances C. They formed the Razakars D. They ruled Hyderabad from 1940

Answer: B. Communist organizers helped coordinate collective action, but village initiative and local agrarian conditions were crucial. Party leadership and peasant agency must both be considered.

MCQ 12. Chakali Ailamma is remembered particularly for

A. Defending a cultivated harvest against landlord coercion B. Signing the Standstill Agreement C. Commanding the Hyderabad army D. Founding the MIM

Answer: A. Ailamma's resistance around Palakurthi illustrates tenancy, caste, gender and sangham solidarity. Exact disputed legal or acreage details should not be invented.

MCQ 13. Which of the following describes women's participation most fully?

A. Women participated only as observers B. Women organized, sheltered, communicated and sometimes fought C. Women held every movement leadership office D. Women participated only after 1951

Answer: B. Women's roles included organizing, provisioning, carrying information and in some cases armed resistance. Their participation did not automatically eliminate patriarchy.

MCQ 14. Why is it wrong to equate the MIM with all Muslims of Hyderabad?

A. MIM was a geographical district B. Political affiliation and communal identity are not the same C. The MIM was a communist peasant sangham D. All Muslims opposed the Nizam

Answer: B. The MIM was a specific political organization; Muslim residents held diverse positions, and some opposed Razakar violence. Collective blame is historically inaccurate.

MCQ 15. Qasim Razvi is most directly linked with

A. The Razakar movement in late princely Hyderabad B. The 1857 Gond uprising C. The 1956 States Reorganisation Commission D. The founding of the Indian National Congress

Answer: A. Razvi led the hardline Razakar-associated political movement during the 1947–48 crisis. This should be distinguished from the regular Hyderabad State forces.

MCQ 16. The Razakars are best distinguished from

A. All civilian Muslims B. The regular Hyderabad State army and the entire MIM membership C. The Nizam's sovereignty dispute D. The 1947 crisis

Answer: B. The Razakars were an armed volunteer organization associated with hardline MIM politics. Institutional distinctions prevent exaggeration and collective stereotyping.

MCQ 17. What changed for princely Hyderabad in August 1947?

A. British paramountcy lapsed B. Telangana state was formed C. Operation Polo ended D. The peasant struggle was withdrawn

Answer: A. The lapse of paramountcy opened an accession and sovereignty dispute. It did not itself settle Hyderabad's relationship with the Indian Union.

MCQ 18. The Standstill Agreement was intended mainly to

A. Complete final accession immediately B. Maintain arrangements temporarily during negotiation C. Create a communist government D. Partition Telangana from Hyderabad

Answer: B. The agreement created temporary arrangements while negotiations continued. It should not be confused with a permanent sovereignty settlement.

MCQ 19. Operation Polo began on which date?

A. 13 September 1948 B. 17 September 1951 C. 15 August 1947 D. 1 November 1956

Answer: A. Indian forces entered Hyderabad on 13 September 1948. The Nizam's cessation of resistance was announced on 17 September.

MCQ 20. Which statement accurately describes "Police Action"?

A. A purely civilian police investigation B. An official label for a military operation C. A 1951 peasant withdrawal conference D. A tribal forest settlement

Answer: B. Police Action was the contemporary official description of Operation Polo, which used organized Indian military forces.

MCQ 21. What is the key distinction between 17 September 1948 and 1951?

A. Both mark Hyderabad's original independence B. 1948 marks military integration; 1951 marks withdrawal of communist-led armed struggle C. 1951 marks Bheem's death D. 1948 marks creation of Telangana state

Answer: B. Integration ended the princely sovereignty dispute, but agrarian armed resistance continued under changed conditions until its withdrawal in 1951.

MCQ 22. Why should exact figures from the Sunderlal investigation be qualified?

A. No investigation was undertaken B. Its methodology and source access require scrutiny, and estimates are not a census C. It concerns only ancient history D. It was the 2024 syllabus

Answer: B. The post-1948 investigation is important evidence of civilian suffering, but estimated casualties require contextual reading of the original report and its sampling limitations.

MCQ 23. Which claim about Ramji Gond is least defensible without original documentation?

A. He figures in Gond historical memory B. Resistance is remembered around Nirmal C. An exact number of people were executed on a specific day D. His history concerns northern Telangana

Answer: C. Precise troop or execution figures repeated in popular narratives can conceal disagreement in source chronology. A claim-level primary-source audit is needed.

MCQ 24. Which causal chain best explains village political change?

A. Vetti collective sangham organization challenge to local coercion B. 1948 integration 1857 rebellion C. Razakars ancient Satavahana rule D. 1951 withdrawal 1940 Jodeghat

Answer: A. Organization converted individual grievances into collective demands. A sangham could challenge everyday power over labour, crops and land.

MCQ 25. Which source is strongest for the exact official 2024 syllabus wording?

A. A generic coaching blog B. TGPSC Notification 02/2024 Annexure II C. A memoir written in 1960 D. An unreferenced social-media post

Answer: B. The commission-hosted Notification 02/2024 Annexure II is the primary authority for syllabus wording. Coaching summaries are secondary.

MCQ 26. Which pairing of event and date is correct?

A. Bheem at Jodeghat—1940; Operation Polo—1948 B. Bheem at Jodeghat—1951; Operation Polo—1860 C. Komaraiah at Kadavendi—1857; Operation Polo—1956 D. Ramji Gond—2014; Operation Polo—1940

Answer: A. The broad chronology is secure: Bheem died in 1940; Operation Polo occurred in September 1948. Avoid unsupported precision about Bheem's day of death.

MCQ 27. Which factor makes a single "Hindu versus Muslim" account inadequate?

A. There was no religious violence B. Class, locality, state institutions and varied political positions also shaped conflict C. All villagers were communists D. Hyderabad had no princely ruler

Answer: B. Communal violence occurred, but agrarian grievances, Razakar coercion, political diversity and post-action reprisals also matter. Community-wide labels erase complexity.

MCQ 28. Which is the most defensible interpretation of 1948 integration?

A. All Telangana inequalities ended overnight B. Princely sovereignty changed decisively, while social conflicts persisted C. The 1946 struggle never happened D. Hyderabad became a separate Telangana state

Answer: B. The military and constitutional transition was decisive but did not automatically resolve tenancy, caste and land conflicts or end the armed peasant struggle.

MCQ 29. The 2026 Telangana Praja Palana Dinotsavam report is primary evidence for

A. What happened inside every village in 1948 B. The Telangana government's 2026 commemoration and interpretation C. Exact 1860 Gond casualty totals D. The original Standstill Agreement wording

Answer: B. A contemporary government press release establishes how an event is commemorated in 2026, not all disputed facts about the event in 1948.

MCQ 30. Which evidence pairing is methodologically appropriate?

A. Oral tradition for community memory; archival records for precise official orders B. Government speech for exact 1860 execution list C. Modern memorial for a verbatim 1940 slogan D. Uncited blog for a verified official PYQ

Answer: A. Different evidence types answer different questions. Oral traditions illuminate memory and identity; contemporary records are stronger for exact dated official actions, though both need critical scrutiny.

Six structured original mains model answers (not official PYQs)

Q1. Explain the agrarian causes and consequences of the Telangana peasant armed struggle.

Introduction — The Telangana peasant armed struggle arose from a combination of unequal land relations, insecure tenancy, vetti, illegal exactions and the political power of landlords and local intermediaries. These problems were especially acute where deshmukhs and other dominant landholders exercised influence over land, credit and village administration. The struggle therefore cannot be explained only as a party-led ideological revolt.

Main developments — Andhra Mahasabha activists helped transform cultural and civil-liberty organization into rural mobilization. Communist organizers increasingly worked through village sanghams, which demanded an end to forced labour, resisted eviction and mobilized peasants around land. Doddi Komaraiah's killing in 1946 became an important symbolic turning point. As repression intensified, armed squads emerged and in some areas local organizations displaced landlord authority and redistributed or protected land.

Further analysis — The movement also involved women as organizers, couriers and participants, although patriarchal constraints remained. After Indian military intervention in September 1948, the struggle continued under changed conditions against the Indian state before the Communist Party withdrew it in 1951.

Conclusion — Its immediate military objectives were not fully realized, but the movement weakened the legitimacy of coercive agrarian relations, placed tenancy and land reform at the center of regional politics and created a lasting memory of peasant organization. Its major consequence was therefore both institutional and political: it reshaped expectations about land, labour and rural authority in Telangana.

Q2. Assess Komaram Bheem as an Adivasi resistance leader.

Introduction — Komaram Bheem occupies a central place in the political memory of Telangana because his resistance expressed Adivasi claims over land, forest and local autonomy under the Nizam's rule. His historical significance should be located in the changing forest and revenue order of Adilabad rather than reduced to a heroic biography.

Main developments — Gond communities depended on forests, shifting or settled cultivation and local resource systems. Administrative restrictions, claims by officials or outsiders and coercive extraction could turn customary livelihood practices into sites of conflict. Bheem's mobilization emerged from these pressures. He was killed at Jodeghat in 1940, and his death became a powerful symbol of tribal resistance.

Further analysis — The phrase "Jal, Jangal, Zameen" is widely associated with his legacy because it succinctly expresses rights over water, forest and land. However, historians should distinguish later commemorative usage from securely documented contemporary wording. This does not diminish the movement; it strengthens historical accuracy.

Conclusion — Bheem's importance lies in showing that anti-authoritarian politics in Telangana was not confined to urban nationalists or peasant class organizations. Adivasi communities articulated a distinct politics of territory, livelihood and self-rule. His legacy remains relevant to contemporary debates over forest rights and tribal autonomy, provided symbolic memory is kept separate from unverified detail.

Q3. Why did the Hyderabad crisis culminate in Operation Polo in September 1948?

Introduction — The Hyderabad crisis of 1947–48 arose from the collision of princely sovereignty, Indian territorial integration, internal democratic movements and worsening security conditions. When British paramountcy lapsed in 1947, the Nizam initially sought to preserve Hyderabad's independent position rather than accede immediately to India.

Main developments — A Standstill Agreement temporarily maintained existing arrangements while negotiations continued, but the relationship deteriorated. Hyderabad's geographic position inside India, opposition to autocratic rule within the state and the growing activity of the Razakars deepened Indian concerns. Under Qasim Razvi, the Razakar movement became associated with armed intimidation and violence, while agrarian conflict and communal insecurity intensified in parts of the state.

Further analysis — India argued that the situation threatened internal security and that a sovereign enclave in the center of the Union was untenable. Hyderabad, in turn, accused India of coercion and sought diplomatic alternatives. Negotiations failed to resolve the crisis.

Conclusion — On 13 September 1948, Indian forces entered Hyderabad in Operation Polo, officially called a Police Action. The campaign ended within days, and the Nizam announced cessation of resistance on 17 September. The operation settled the strategic question of Hyderabad's position, but it did not end all violence or agrarian conflict. Thus, Operation Polo was the culmination of failed negotiation, internal political crisis and the Indian state's determination to complete territorial integration.

Q4. "17 September 1948 ended princely sovereignty but not Telangana's social conflicts." Discuss.

Argument 1 — The integration of Hyderabad State into the Indian Union in September 1948 transformed the constitutional position of the Nizam, but it did not immediately resolve the social conflicts that had produced mass politics in Telangana.

Argument 2 — Operation Polo ended Hyderabad's attempt to maintain an independent strategic position. The Nizam's government ceased military resistance, and effective authority moved into the framework of the Indian Union. This was a decisive political transition from princely sovereignty toward democratic constitutional government.

Argument 3 — Yet the Telangana peasant armed struggle continued after September 1948. Communist-led squads and village organizations had mobilized around land, tenancy, vetti and landlord coercion. Their conflict was not simply with the Nizam as an individual ruler; it concerned the structure of agrarian power. Under changed circumstances, armed resistance continued against Indian security forces until the Communist Party withdrew the struggle in 1951.

Argument 4 — The integration period also witnessed communal and political violence whose history cannot be reduced to a single victorious narrative. Later land reforms and electoral politics addressed some grievances but did not instantly eliminate rural inequality.

Argument 5 — Therefore, 17 September is best understood as a constitutional and military turning point, not the end of Telangana's social history. It resolved the question of princely statehood while struggles over land, caste, regional inequality and democratic representation continued in new forms.

Q5. Explain the role of village sanghams and women in the Telangana peasant struggle.

Introduction — The Telangana peasant armed struggle of 1946–51 grew from unequal land relations, forced labour and coercion by local elites. Village sanghams transformed scattered grievances into collective political action, while women sustained organization and challenged the limits of public participation.

Sangham institutions — Sanghams convened meetings, coordinated refusal of vetti, defended tenants threatened with eviction and organized support across settlements. Their practical power lay in reducing the isolation of cultivators facing landlords or village officials. In some localities they helped protect harvests, mediate disputes and challenge customary authority. Their influence was uneven and should not be confused with permanent control of every village.

Women's agency — Women acted as organizers, couriers, cultivators, providers of shelter and supplies and, in some cases, armed participants. Chakali Ailamma's resistance around Palakurthi illustrates how a struggle over a cultivated harvest could combine caste, gender, tenancy and sangham solidarity. Women's work also maintained families and communication networks under repression.

Limitations and conclusion — Participation did not automatically end patriarchal leadership, unequal domestic burdens or violence against women. Moreover, movement accounts sometimes emphasize dramatic battles more than everyday organizational labour. The sanghams' achievement was to make local authority contestable; women's participation broadened the social base and political meaning of that challenge. Both were essential, but neither should be romanticized as a complete social revolution.

Q6. Compare Adivasi resistance and the Telangana peasant armed struggle under Hyderabad State.

Introduction — Resistance in Telangana developed in different periods and social settings. Ramji Gond's nineteenth-century memory, Komaram Bheem's forest-based struggle ending in 1940, and the peasant armed movement of 1946–51 shared opposition to coercion but did not constitute a single continuous organization.

Adivasi movements — Gond resistance focused on community autonomy, customary land use, forest access and the authority of officials or outsiders. Ramji Gond is associated with the Nirmal region, although precise execution details remain disputed. Komaram Bheem mobilized in the Adilabad–Jodeghat zone; his legacy is expressed through the remembered language of water, forest and land rights.

Peasant mobilization — The later armed struggle arose from insecure tenancy, vetti, illegal levies and landlord dominance. Andhra Mahasabha activists and Communist cadres helped build village sanghams. The killing of Doddi Komaraiah in 1946 intensified mobilization, and organized resistance in some places challenged landlord power and established alternative village authority.

Comparison and conclusion — Adivasi struggles centred distinctive forest and territorial claims; the peasant movement developed a wider agrarian class programme with party organization. Both included local initiative and faced repression. Their source bases differ: oral memory is particularly important for earlier resistance, while organizational documents and scholarship are more extensive for 1946–51. A balanced interpretation recognizes shared demands for dignity without erasing their different aims, chronologies and political languages.

Answer blueprints and rapid revision

• **Agrarian causes:** institutional land structure tenancy/vetti Andhra Mahasabha and Communist organization sanghams 1946–51 reforms/limitations.

• **Bheem:** Gond ecology forest/revenue conflict Jodeghat 1940 legacy and slogan provenance continuing land rights.

• **Operation Polo:** paramountcy Nizam position Standstill Agreement Razakars/internal movements 13–17 September 1948 violence and administrative transition.

• **1948 versus 1951:** constitutional integration versus continued agrarian armed struggle; evaluate differing outcomes.

• **Sanghams and women:** collective action mechanisms Ailamma gendered labour limits of emancipation.

• **Comparative resistance:** Ramji Gond versus Bheem versus communist-led peasants: chronology, goals, organization, sources and legacy.

Revision traps: (a) Jodeghat is not Kadavendi; (b) MIM is not identical to the Razakars or all Muslims; (c) 1948 integration did not end the 1946–51 peasant struggle; (d) modern memorial language is not always a verified historical quotation; (e) government commemorations are evidence of present-day memory, not original archival evidence.

Official PYQ provenance: zero commission-hosted past questions authenticated in this edition. All 30 MCQs and six mains answers above are ORIGINAL PRACTICE.